

DONGCHEN ZHAO

Department of Economics

University of Cincinnati Lindner College of Business

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CURRENT POSITION

Assistant Professor of Economics, University of Cincinnati, 2024 – present

PAST EMPLOYMENT

Visiting Scholar, The University of Chicago Becker Friedman Institute, 2023

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS AT AUSTIN, AUSTIN TX

Ph.D. in Economics 2023

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, SAN DIEGO, LA JOLLA CA

B.S. in Mathematics and Economics, Summa Cum Laude, 2018

RESEARCH FIELDS

Macroeconomics, Finance, Macro Labor

DISSERTATION

Essays on Firm Dynamics and Financial Frictions

REFERENCE

Ayşegül Şahin, University of Texas at Austin

Andreas I. Mueller, University of Texas at Austin

Saroj Bhattarai, University of Texas at Austin

WORKING PAPERS

"A Structural Anatomy of Corporate Intangible Investments" (*joint with [Ha Bui](#) and [Anushka Mitra](#)*)

"Low Interest Rates, Debt Heterogeneity, and Firm Dynamics"

"Labor Market Outcomes and Welfare of Involuntary Part-Time Workers"

"The Effects of Regulation Restrictions on Firm Dynamism: Evidence from a Shift-Share Instrument"

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Worker Reallocation in Internal and External Labor Markets" (*Joint with [Sadhika Bagga](#)*)

"The Dynamics of Firms' Customer Base" (*joint with [Ha Bui](#) and [Minseog Kim](#)*)

"Idiosyncratic Expectations and Labor Market Outcomes" (*Joint with [Sadhika Bagga](#) and [Anushka Mitra](#)*)

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITY

Presentation: ASSA (2026)*, SED Winter (2024), Chicago Fed (2023), Kent Firm Workshop 2023 (Kent), LBJ Policy Research Workshop (UT Austin), The Young Economist Symposium 2022 (Yale), TX Conference for Macro Job Market Candidates 2022 (Texas A&M), Midwest Macro conference 2022 (SMU)

Ad-hoc Reviewer: American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics, Economics Bulletin

** presented by coauthor*

HONORS, SCHOLARSHIPS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

Faculty Development Award, University of Cincinnati, 2025

Faculty Development Award, University of Cincinnati, 2024

Taft International Conference Travel Grant, University of Cincinnati, 2024

Taft Domestic Conference Travel Grant, University of Cincinnati, 2024

Professional Development Awards, University of Texas at Austin, 2021, 2022

Graduate School Fellowship, University of Texas at Austin, 2018 – 2023

Version: Jan 2026

Graduate School Supplement Fellowship, University of Texas at Austin, 2018
– 2023

Department Honor with Highest Distinction, University of California, San
Diego, 2018

OTHERS

Language: Mandarin (native), English (fluent)